

Contents

1	It's Easy	4
2	How a Key Opens a Lock	5
3	The Flatland Model	7
4	Basic Picking & The Binding Defect	9
5	The Pin Column Model	11
6	Basic Scrubbing	17
7	Advanced Lock Picking	21
7.1	Mechanical Skills	21
7.2	Zen and the Art of Lock Picking	21
7.3	Analytic Thinking	22
8	Exercises	23
8.1	Exercise 1: Bouncing the pick	23
8.2	Exercise 2: Picking pressure	24
8.3	Exercise 3: Picking Torque	24
8.4	Exercise 4: Identifying Set Pins	25
8.5	Exercise 5: Projection	25
9	Recognizing and Exploiting Personality Traits	27
9.1	Which Way To Turn	27
9.2	How Far to Turn	29
9.3	Gravity	29
9.4	Pins Not Setting	29
9.5	Elastic Deformation	29

Distribution

Copyright 1987, 1991 Theodore T. Tool. All rights reserved.

Permission to reproduce this document on a non-profit basis is granted provided that this copyright and distribution notice is included in full. The information in this booklet is provided for educational purposes only.

August 1991 revision.

MIT Guide to Lock Picking

Ted the Tool

September 1, 1991